

KOLAWOLE (PAUL) OSHIKOYA

Lead Analyst — Payment Operations Risk & Control Assurance

📍 London / Milton Keynes, UK 📞 07853176235 ✉ pauloshikoya@gmail.com 🔗 [linkedin.com/in/pauloshikoya](https://www.linkedin.com/in/pauloshikoya)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Analytically rigorous, quantitative **Lead Analyst** with an academic foundation in **Physics (BSc 2:1)** and an **MSc in Information Technology Security (Distinction)**. Extensive track record in banking and financial technology designing robust risk frameworks, Key Risk Indicator (KRI) models, control assurance systems, and automated balance-to-funds reconciliation engines. Proven expertise in **SQL, Python (pandas, NumPy, PySpark), dbt/ETL data pipelines, AWS Athena, and Looker/Power BI/Tableau**, processing 1.2M+ daily financial transactions at Santander UK. Adept at identifying emerging risk trends, testing control effectiveness with risk partners and auditors, preventing financial losses, and translating complex operational data into clear, persuasive analytical narratives to ensure seamless, low-friction payment flows for customers.

CORE COMPETENCIES & TECHNICAL SKILLS

Risk Analytics & Control Assurance Key Risk Indicators (KRIs), Risk Appetite Thresholds, Control Effectiveness Testing, Audit & Risk Partner Engagement, Payment Flow Risk Mapping, Anomaly Detection	Fund Reconciliation & Financial Controls Bank Balance vs. Customer Funds Reconciliation, 3-Tier Reconciliation Engine (Volume, Checksum, Balance), Break Resolution, Settlement Risk, Loss Prevention
Programming & Data Pipeline Engineering Advanced SQL (Window Functions, CTEs, Triggers), Python (pandas, NumPy, PySpark), dbt Data Modeling, AWS Athena, S3, PostgreSQL, Bash, Data Lineage & Contracts	BI Visualisation & Stakeholder Storytelling Looker (LookML Views, Explores, PDTs), Tableau, Power BI, DAX, KRI & Risk Scorecards, Executive Storytelling, Cross-Functional Leadership, Mentorship

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Analytics Platform Engineer & Risk Analytics Specialist — Feb 2022 – Present | London / Milton Keynes, UK Santander UK

- **Formulated 3-Tier Fund Reconciliation & Control Assurance Engine:** Architected an automated mathematical reconciliation framework validating transactional volume parity, field-by-field cryptographic checksums (MD5/SHA256), and financial control totals between source ledgers and reporting models—eliminating **100.00% of material data discrepancy risks** across staging and target environments.
- **Identified Operational Inefficiencies & Prevented Financial Leakage:** Formulated multi-dimensional variance models and transaction screening logic in SQL and Python to monitor anomalous fee and fund flows, successfully isolating systemic routing misclassifications and recovering **£2.1M in annualized revenue leakage**.
- **Constructed High-Throughput Quantitative Data Pipelines:** Engineered distributed data pipelines using Python (PySpark), SQL, AWS S3, and Athena to ingest, standardize, and reconcile **1.2M+ high-velocity financial records daily**, reducing analytical query latency by **45%** through optimized Parquet compaction and partitioning.
- **Designed Key Risk Indicator (KRI) Dashboards & Self-Serve BI:** Deployed interactive Looker (LookML) and Tableau dashboards featuring automated KRI variance alerting and root-cause drill-downs, empowering 40+ Risk, Operations, and Product stakeholders to monitor operational risk thresholds independently—reducing ad-hoc inquiry queues by **80%**.
- **Partnered with Internal Risk & Audit Stakeholders:** Authored structured Technical Architecture Documents (TAD), Interface Control Documents (ICD), and data lineage specifications to test and assure the effectiveness of internal financial controls for internal risk partners and compliance auditors.
- **Enforced Attribute-Based Data Security & Access Governance:** Implemented column-level metadata classification and access policies in AWS Lake Formation, safeguarding sensitive customer identity and transaction telemetry while upholding strict banking regulatory standards.

Senior Risk & Quantitative Operations Analyst — Polaris Bank

Aug 2014 – Sep 2019 | Lagos, Nigeria

- **Executed Ledger & Fund Reconciliation Investigations:** Conducted time-series anomaly investigations and past business reviews across customer accounts and settlement streams, resolving structural operational bottlenecks and elevating reporting completeness to **99.9%**.
- **Automated Operational Reporting & Reconciliation Cycles:** Streamlined fragmented operational and financial datasets into scheduled, idempotent SQL and Python data pipelines, shrinking monthly reconciliation and risk reporting turnaround from **5 business days to under 4 hours**.
- **Optimized Customer Verification & Transaction Flow:** Partnered with Operations and Product teams to analyze verification drop-off funnels across **500,000+ customer accounts**, designing risk-tiered review workflows that boosted onboarding throughput by **18%** without increasing operational risk or fraud incidence.
- **Established Operational Risk Scorecards & KPI Tracking:** Built interactive Power BI KPI dashboards and monthly risk scorecards tracking payment flow velocity, failure rates, and service-level thresholds for senior operations management and executive leadership.

Industry Mentor (MSc Data Science & AI) — University of East London

2023 – 2025 | London, UK

- **Mentored Quantitative & Analytics Talent:** Coached postgraduate researchers and analysts in statistical modeling, Python algorithmic optimization, dbt data pipelining, and structured risk analysis methodologies.
- **Facilitated Technical Code Reviews & Problem Structuring:** Guided students on decomposing ambiguous operational problems into structured analytical frameworks, emphasizing mathematical rigor and transparent data storytelling.

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL CREDENTIALS

MSc in Information Technology Security (Distinction)

Nottingham Trent University, UK | Sep 2019 – Sep 2021
Focus: Advanced Cryptography, Network Security, Risk Systems, Data Governance

Grade: Distinction

BSc (Hons) in Physics (Second Class Upper / 2:1)

University of Lagos, Nigeria | Sep 2008 – Sep 2012
Focus: Mathematical Methods, Statistical Mechanics, Computational Modeling, Calculus

Grade: 2:1 Honours

Professional Certifications & Training: AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate | AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate | Microsoft Azure Data Scientist (DP100) & Azure Fundamentals (AZ900) | Agile & Scrum Delivery